

Disperse Orange



What is it?

Disperse orange is a textile dye used for synthetic fabrics. Blended fabrics (e.g. polyester-cotton blends) may also use these dyes.

Since this is an orange dye, it is found in orange fabrics, but since most colors are created by blending dyes, the clothing does not need to be orange to cause a problem.

DISPERSE ORANGE can also be known as:

- 4-[(4-nitrophenyl)azo]benzenamine
- 4-Amino-4'-nitroazobenzene
- 4-((4-nitrophenyl)diazenyl)-n-phenylaniline
- Disperse Orange-3
- Disperse Orange-1

Some Possible Uses of DISPERSE ORANGE / Where it might be found:

- Polyester
- Acetate and Triacetate
- Acetate Rayon
- Nylon
- Spandex/Lycra
- Acrylics and Modacrylics
- Polypropylene/Olefins
- Microfibers
- Blends that use the above fabrics or fibers

Potential sources of fabrics that may contain Disperse Orange Dye:

- Clothing, dark clothing liners, socks
- Carpets, bedding
- Polyamide fiber of knot dyeing and roll dye
- Viscose fabric printing
- Baseball cap bill
- Bedding
- Bodysuits

- Ballpoint pen inks
- Polyester velour
- Headbands
- Lycra/Spandex sports clothing and gear
- Lining for slacks, suits
- Nylon stockings and underwear
- Pantyhose
- Plastics
- Polyester blouses
- Seatbelts
- Shoulder pads
- Some diapers
- Swimsuits
- Synthetic wigs
- Textile blends
- Uniforms (e.g. airline, policeman, seaman)

Other products that might react like DISPERSE ORANGE:

- Other disperse dyes
- "para-amino" compounds (i.e. paraphenylenediamine, parabens, benzocaine anesthetics, para-amino benzoic acid family of sunscreens, 4,4-diamino diphenylmethane, thiurams, aminoazobenzene, para-toluenediamine sulfate)

What should I do to avoid DISPERSE ORANGE?

Allergy to textile dyes often shows up as a rash at sites where friction or perspiration causes contact with the dye. Sweat may increase the release of dye from fabrics. Commonly affected areas are the inner thighs, backs of knees, buttocks, waist, genitalia, around the armpit and tops of feet (from dyes in shoe fabrics).

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Most people will have fewer problems with light colored and loose-fitting garments. Another option is to remove offending dark linings and replace them with a white liner. Dyes are permanent and cannot be washed out of clothing. Repeated washing does not protect you from contact allergy to textile dyes. If a suspected garment must be worn, try 100% silk or cotton long underwear underneath it.

Usually, the following fabrics are safe:

- 100% cotton
- 100% rayon (viscose, viscose rayon)
- Rayon variants (Modal, Tencel/Lyocell)
- 100% silk
- 100% linen
- 100% wool
- 100% hemp
- 100% bamboo

In addition, the ACDS Contact Allergen Management Program® (CAMP®) can help manage contact dermatitis. It helps to find products that are safe to use by creating a list of products that do not contain one's allergens. For more information about CAMP®, please ask your doctor or visit www.contactderm.org.

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